

SAFE TREATMENT PROTOCOL

Laser Hair Removal — 808 nm Diode

A step-by-step, safety-first protocol for staff. Works best on **dark hair, lighter skin**; gray/white/fine light hair responds poorly.

Read first: The device auto-presets energy & pulse from the skin type and area you select. The ranges below are **conservative starting points** to sanity-check those presets — not fixed prescriptions. Your Medical Director sets and approves final limits. **Always test-spot and start at the low end.**

Starting parameters by skin type

FITZPATRICK	MENU	START FLUENCE*	PULSE WIDTH	COOLING
I-II	White	~16–30 J/cm ²	short–med (10–30 ms)	High
III-IV	Medium	~12–24 J/cm ²	medium (20–40 ms)	High
V (& VI w/ provider)	Black	~10–16 J/cm ²	long (30–100 ms)	Max

*Conservative starting ranges for staff to verify against the device preset — device range is 1–120 J/cm², 5–400 ms, 1–10 Hz. Coarse/dense dark hair tolerates the higher end; fine or lighter hair the lower. Darker skin = lower energy, longer pulse, max cooling. **Confirm every value with the Medical Director.**

Adjust by response, not by guessing: if the test spot / area shows no perifollicular redness or edema and the client tolerates it, increase fluency **1–2 J/cm²** and reassess. If pain is high, skin whitens/grays, or blistering appears — **stop**, lower energy, raise cooling, escalate.

Treatment flow

- 1 Screen & consent.** Health form, contraindication check, signed consent, skin + hair type recorded, before photos. Confirm no sun/tanning (4–8 wks) and no plucking/waxing since last visit.
- 2 Prep.** Area clean, dry, and **shaved** (no lotion/deodorant). Water tanks full (distilled, $\leq 2 \mu\text{m}/\text{cm}$); circulate 1 min. Room locked, everyone in goggles, client eye protection, gloves on.
- 3 Set & test.** Select Laser HR, area, and skin type; cooling HIGH. Verify presets against the table above. Fire a **test spot** in a discreet part of the area; wait and confirm a safe response before continuing.
- 4 Treat.** Rest handpiece flush on skin up to 4 s, then pulse. Work a systematic grid with up to 30% overlap, one pass unless protocol says otherwise. Clean the spot with 70% ethanol every 30–40 pulses.
- 5 Endpoint.** Target = mild perifollicular redness / slight edema / warmth. Anything beyond that → stop and reassess settings.
- 6 Finish & chart.** Standby, cold gauze + soothing gel, aftercare review. Wait 5 min before power-off. Record area, skin type, fluence, pulse, passes, and response.

Session plan

Series of **6–8** for most areas. **Face:** every 4 weeks. **Body:** every 6–8 weeks. Only hair in an active growth phase responds, so multiple sessions are required. Re-evaluate after the series; maintenance as needed. Keep same settings visit-to-visit unless response is lacking, then nudge up 1–2 J/cm².

Area notes

Thin/dark-hair areas (underarm, bikini) respond fastest. Coarse dense hair (back, legs) tolerates higher fluence. Face & neck: extra care, lower energy, hair often finer. Stay **$\geq 1.5 \text{ cm}$** from tattoos, moles, or pigmented lesions — never treat over them.

Pre-care (client)

- ✓ No sun / tanning / self-tanner 4–8 weeks
- ✓ Shave the area 12–24 hrs before — do not wax/pluck 4 wks
- ✓ Stop retinoids/acids on the area per screening
- ✓ Clean skin, no lotion, makeup, or deodorant

After-care (client)

- ✓ Cool compress + soothing gel for redness/warmth
- ✓ SPF 50+, avoid sun on area 1 month; no tanning
- ✓ No hot showers, sauna, pool, heavy sweat 24–48 hrs
- ✓ Don't pick; shed hairs fall out over 1–2 wks